

Jackson Clark

PUBLICATIONS

Clark, J., Y. Su, S. M. R. Pial, L. Gniedziejko, and T. Xu (2026). “SREGym: A Live Training Ground for AI SRE Agents with High-Fidelity Failure Drills”. In: *Conference on AI Systems (CAIS), Demo Track*.

Clark*, J., Y. Su*, S. M. R. Pial, Y. Tian, L. Gniedziejko, H.-A. Jacobsen, Y. Chen, and T. Xu (May 2026). “SREGym: A Live Benchmark for AI SRE Agents with High-Fidelity Failure Scenarios”. In: *arXiv:2605.07161*. Supported by a Laude Institute Slingshot Grant. arXiv: 2605.07161.

Chen*, Y., J. Pan*, J. Clark*, Y. Su*, N. Zheutlin, B. Bhavya, R. Arora, Y. Deng, S. Jha, and T. Xu (2025). “STRATUS: A Multi-agent System for Autonomous Reliability Engineering of Modern Clouds”. In: *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)*. Accepted. arXiv: 2506.02009 [cs.DC].

Jha*, S., R. Arora*, Y. Watanabe, T. Yanagawa, Y. Chen, J. Clark, et al. (2025). “ITBench: Evaluating AI Agents across Diverse Real-World IT Automation Tasks”. In: *Proceedings of the 42nd International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)*. Oral Presentation (Top 1%). arXiv: 2502.05352 [cs.AI].

AWARDS

- **Laude Institute Slingshot Grant for SREGym** 2025

EXPERIENCE

Microsoft Research Research Intern, Agentic Innovation – Making agents more reliable.	Redmond, WA (Onsite, Full-Time) Summer 2026
University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign Graduate Research Assistant, xLab – Building the AI for production stack. – Leading SREGym , a live benchmark for AI SRE agents with high-fidelity failure scenarios, supported by a Laude Institute Slingshot Grant (2025). – Co-authored STRATUS (NeurIPS 2025) and ITBench (ICML 2025, Oral, Top 1%); lead maintainer of AIOpsLab (800+ GitHub stars).	Urbana, IL (Onsite, Full-Time) Fall 2024 – Present
NASA Marshall Space Flight Center Software Engineer Intern, Huntsville Operations Support Center (HOSC) – Developed a forward error correction library in C++ based on CCSDS standards (BCH, LDPC, and convolutional codes) for NASA’s GPDM mission. – Contributed to software automation tools supporting flight controllers.	Huntsville, AL (Onsite, Full-Time) Summer 2023
NASA Ames Research Center Research Intern, Intelligent Systems Division – Led reinforcement learning research for multi-agent pathfinding (MAPF) in urban air traffic management, leveraging Python, PyTorch, TensorFlow, and Docker on a supercomputing cluster.	Mountain View, CA (Remote, Full-Time) Summer 2023
NASA Goddard Space Flight Center Software Engineer and Data Science Intern, HEASARC – Spring Project: Trained ML models (scikit-learn, TensorFlow) to classify neutron star spectra using NICER payload data. – Fall Project: Redesigned SkyView, a React + Flask data catalog system for querying astrophysics datasets by sky position.	Greenbelt, MD (Remote, Part-Time) Fall 2022 – Spring 2023
NASA Marshall Space Flight Center Software Engineer Intern, Payload Operations Integration Center – Designed an automation tool for ISS flight controllers to streamline timeline change processes.	Huntsville, AL (Onsite, Full-Time) Summer 2022

INVITED TALKS

- **SREGym** Spring 2026
Microsoft Research, System Intelligence Seminar.

- **STRATUS**
University of Toronto, ECE1770. Hosted by Yifang Tian and Hans-Arno Jacobsen.

March 17, 2026

EDUCATION

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

Ph.D. Computer Science

Urbana, IL

Fall, 2024–Present

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

B.S. in Information Sciences + Data Science, GPA: 3.82/4.00

Urbana, IL

2020–Spring, 2024

TEACHING

- **Instructor** at Discovery Partner's Institute
Designed and taught a 2 week Data Science Intensive program to educate Chicago Public School teachers to create their own data science lessons for their classrooms. Summer 2024, Summer 2025, Summer 2026
- **Course Assistant** at UIUC
Data Science Discovery (CS 107) Spring 2023 - Spring 2024